

Why AI skin looks like wax.

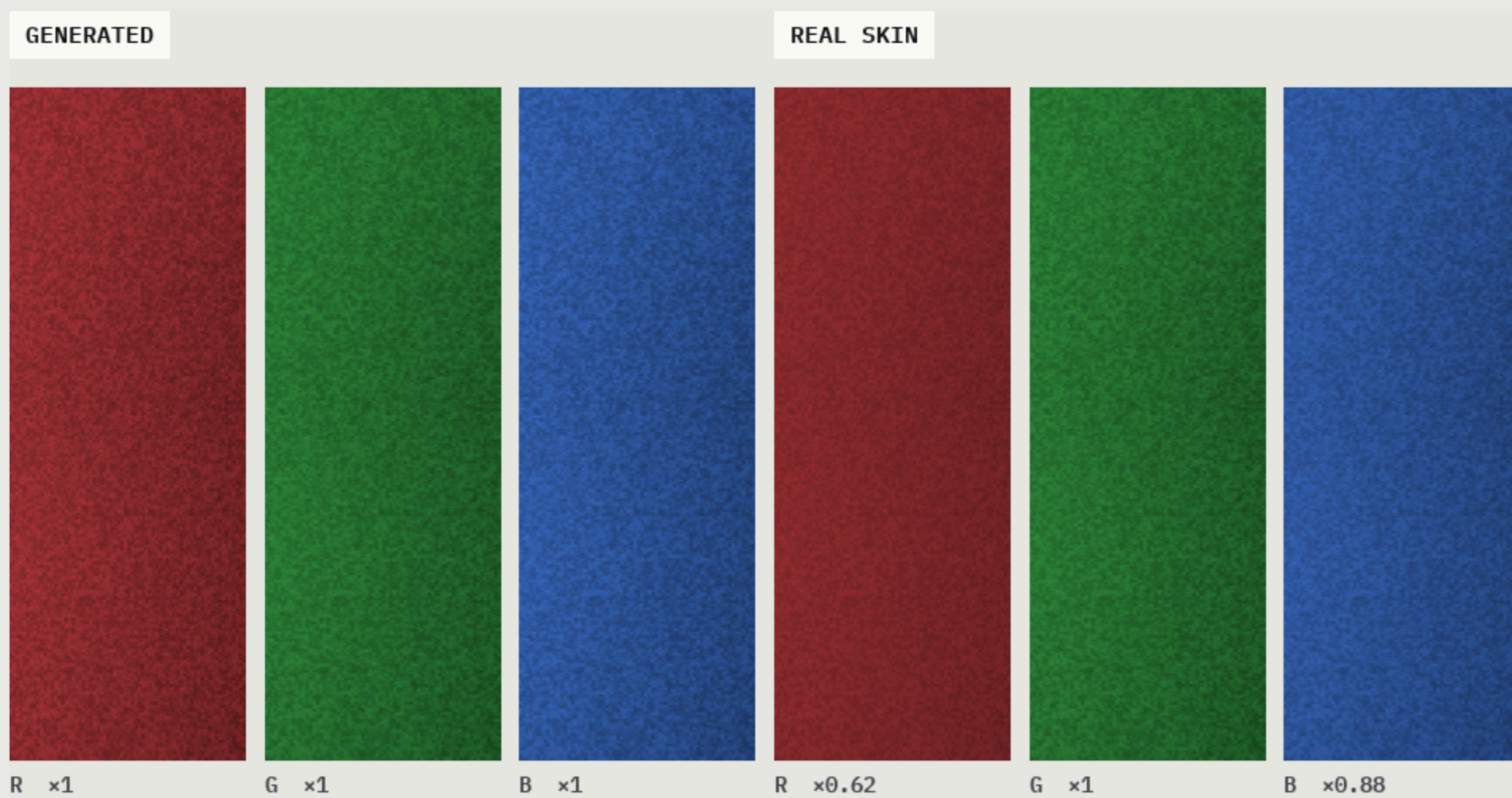
Six signatures that give a generated portrait away.
Prompting fixes none of them.



swipe →

01

The same detail in all three colour channels.



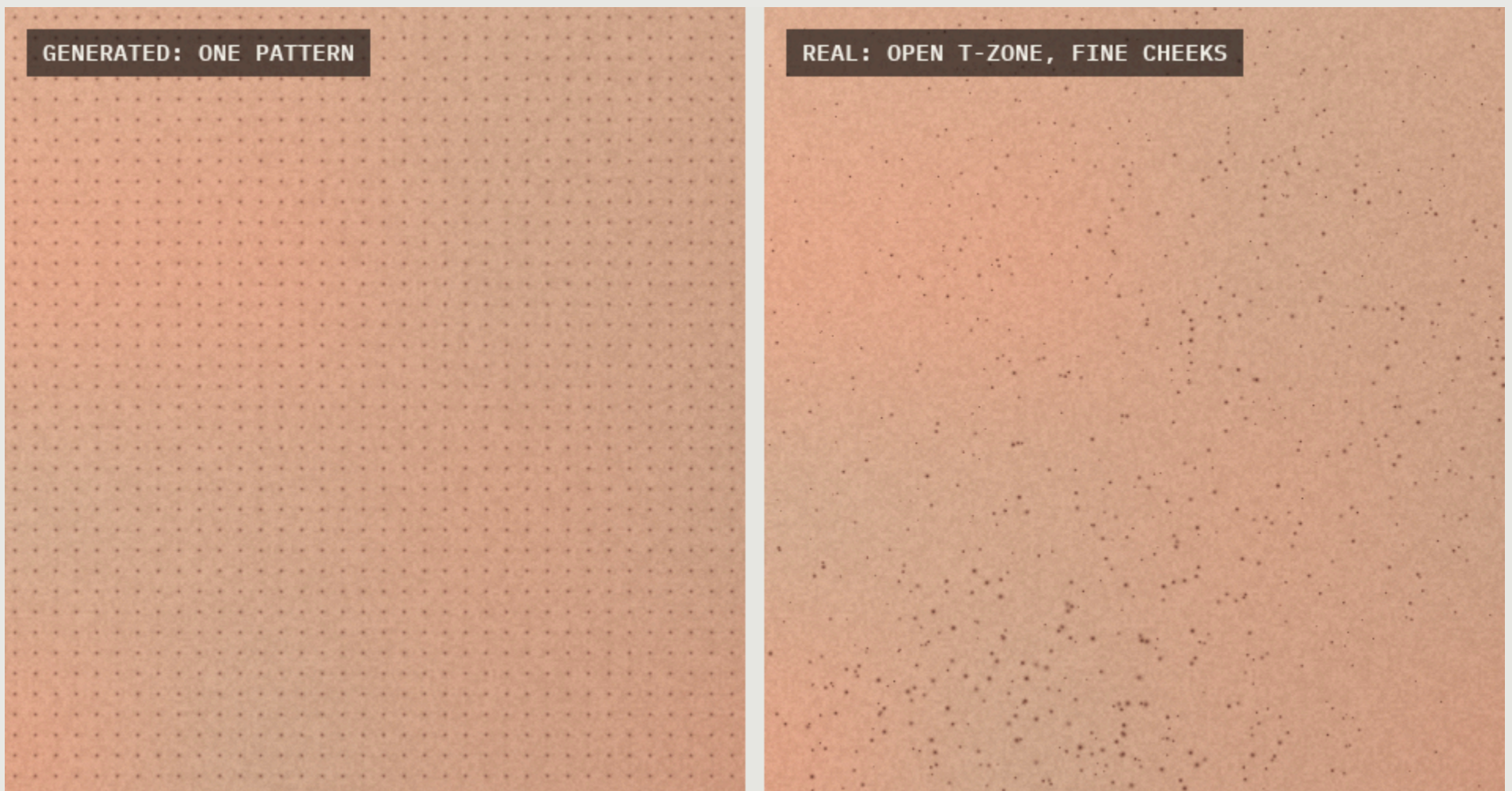
In real skin, red light scatters under the surface, so the red channel carries less fine detail than the green. Generators make red, green and blue equally sharp, and the eye reads plastic with relief.

THE FIX

Graft the detail per channel: red 0.62, green 1, blue 0.88.

02

Pores spaced evenly across the face.



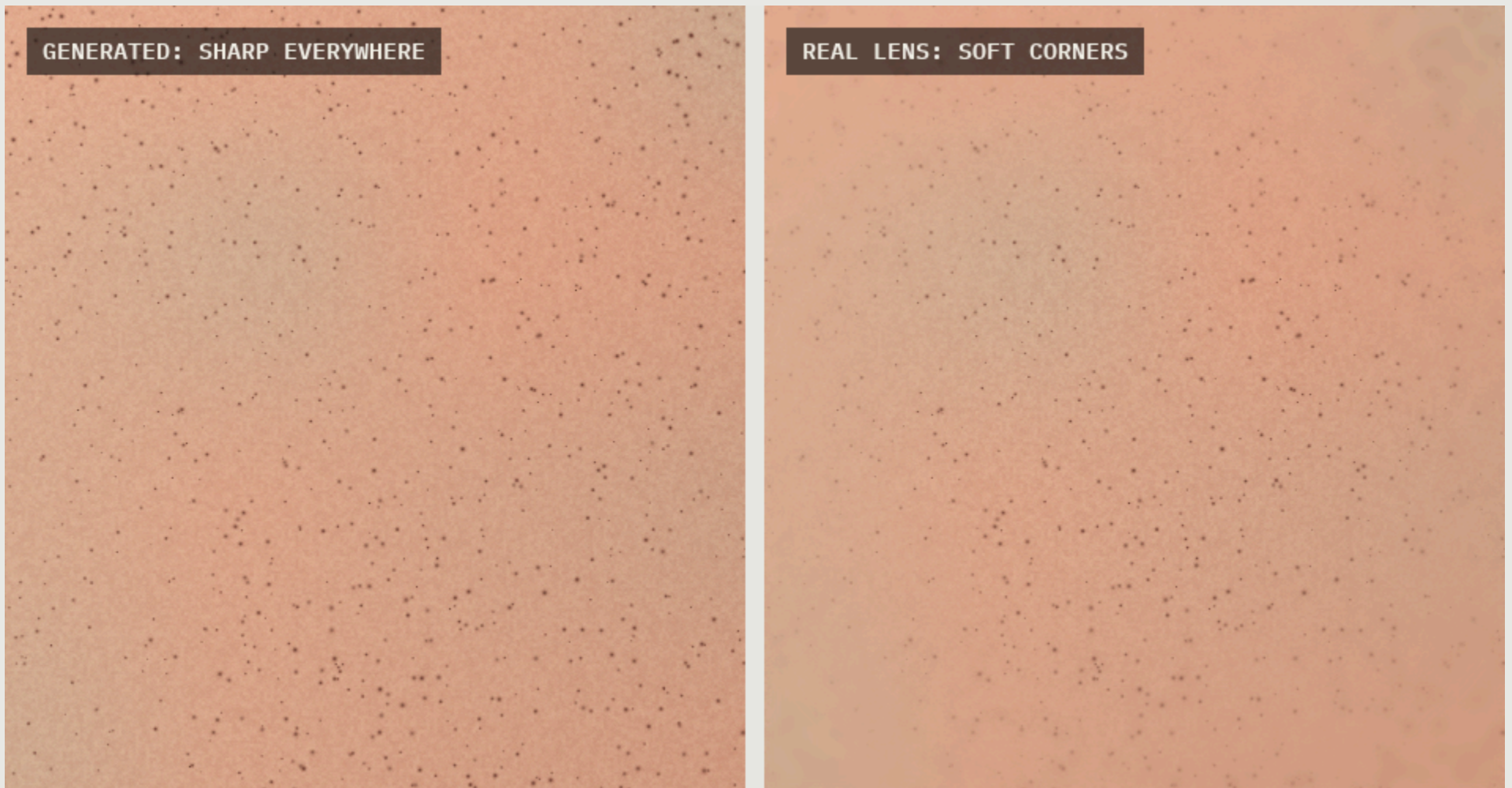
Real skin changes across the face: open pores on the T-zone, fine on the cheeks, vellus hair at the temples. Generated skin repeats one pattern everywhere.

THE FIX

Vary the texture gain with a slow noise field across the face.

03

Sharp from corner to corner.



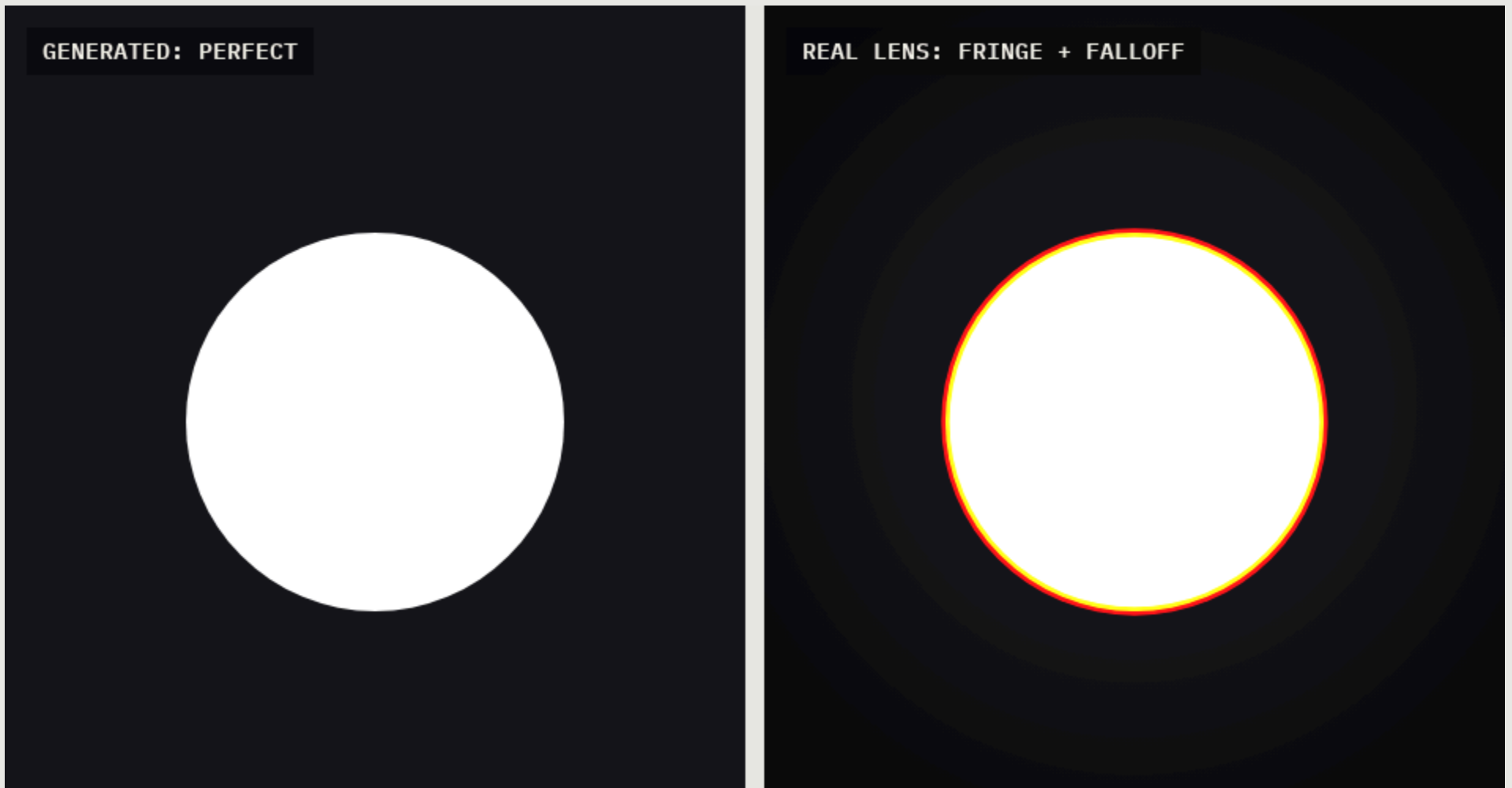
No real lens resolves the corners like the centre. A frame that is equally sharp everywhere reads as a render.

THE FIX

Fade the grafted detail radially toward the corners.

04

Perfect optics.



Real lenses fringe colour on high-contrast edges and lose light in the corners. Generated images have neither.

THE FIX

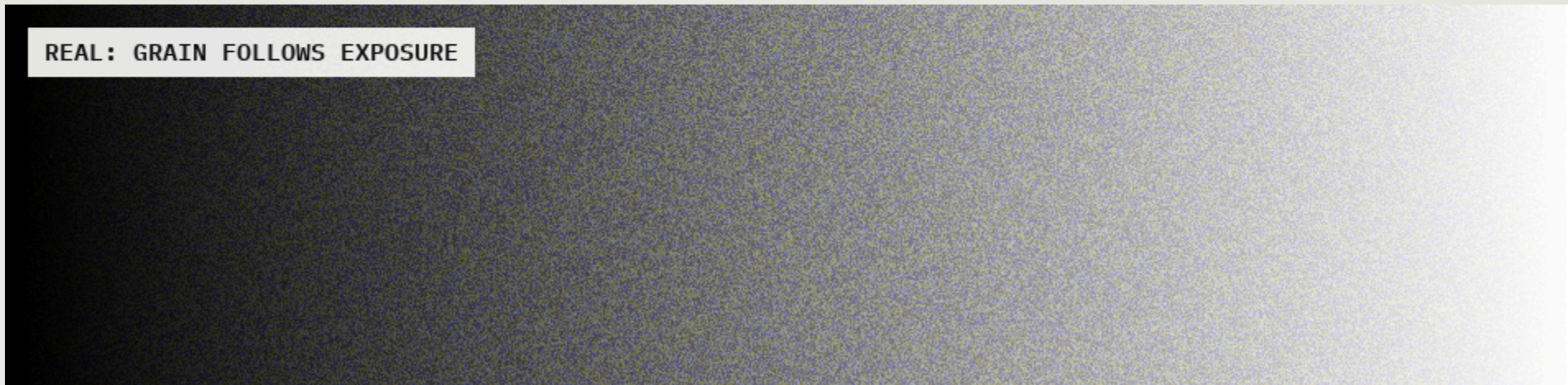
Sub-pixel lateral aberration (red magnifies, blue contracts) and corner falloff.

05

Flat grain.



GENERATED: FLAT GRAIN



REAL: GRAIN FOLLOWS EXPOSURE

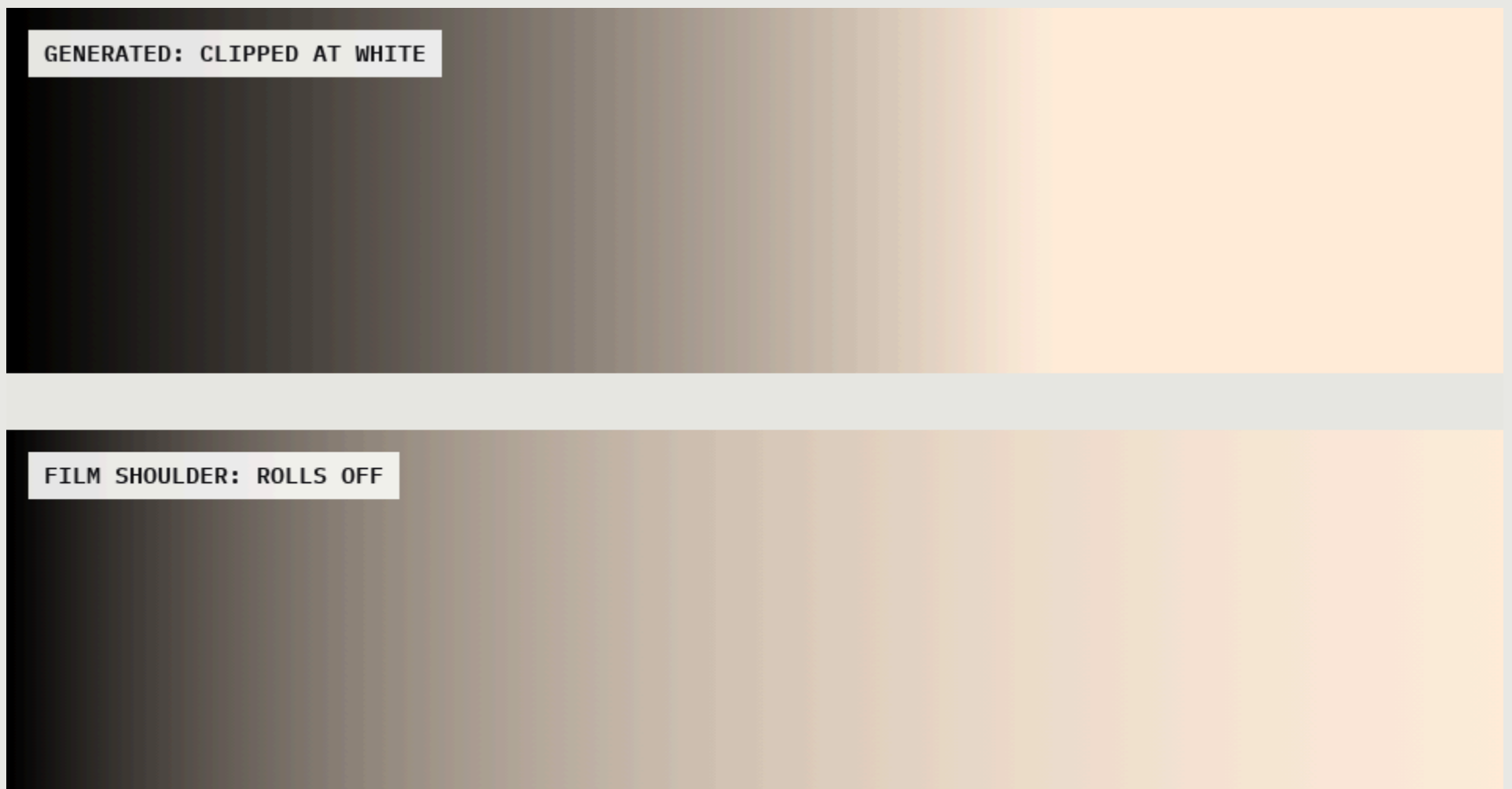
Real grain peaks in the midtones and disappears in pure black and blown highlights. The blue channel grains more than the red.

THE FIX

Clustered grain, weighted by exposure and balanced per channel.

06

Highlights clipped flat.



Film rolls the highlights off gradually. Generated images often cut them dead at white.

THE FIX

A film-style shoulder on the highlights.

All six are built into HERA Skin Lab.

0.33 → 0.83

FIDELITY TO THE ORIGINAL PHOTO

+65%

MICRO-TEXTURE REACHING THE IMAGE

<0.4/255

IDENTITY LEAK, EVEN FED A
DIFFERENT FACE

Measured on my test bench.

heraskinlab.com

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